

PatchBond

Refundable bonds for pull requests

A market for maintainer attention.

Refundable bonds for pull requests on NEAR. Real work gets every cent back. Slop pays the maintainer whose time it wasted — decided by AI anyone can verify.

EIP-1559 for open source

Verifiable AI · NEAR AI Cloud TEE

Live on NEAR testnet

github.com/PatchBond/patchbond

NEAR Hackathon 2026

THE PROBLEM — FROM A MAINTAINER

“Some people just create tens of PRs resolving issues they weren't even assigned to — or claim a PR does what it doesn't do.”

Every one costs a maintainer time to read, check and close. The sender spends ten seconds. The maintainer spends an hour. **Nothing connects the two.**

AI is here to help open source — not to drown it.

WHY NOW

AI made sending free. Receiving still costs a human.

~25%

of incoming pull requests are estimated to be low-quality AI output — **31%** on larger projects.

Linux Foundation Research, Oct 2026

49

AI-slop security reports on curl's public list. curl moved low-severity reports public because AI reports nearly overwhelmed its team.

curl maintainer's public list (gist)

PRs off

GitHub added options to turn pull requests off or limit them to collaborators — shutting honest newcomers out too.

GitHub, Aug 2026

Sources: docs/RESEARCH.md

THE IDEA

Make wasting a maintainer's time cost something.

1 · Bond

Strangers attach a small refundable deposit

USDC on NEAR. Maintainers, collaborators and proven contributors pay $0.

2 · Verifiable AI

A TEE model judges it after CI

Using facts we compute. The response is signed and public.

3 · Settle

Refund — or the repo is paid

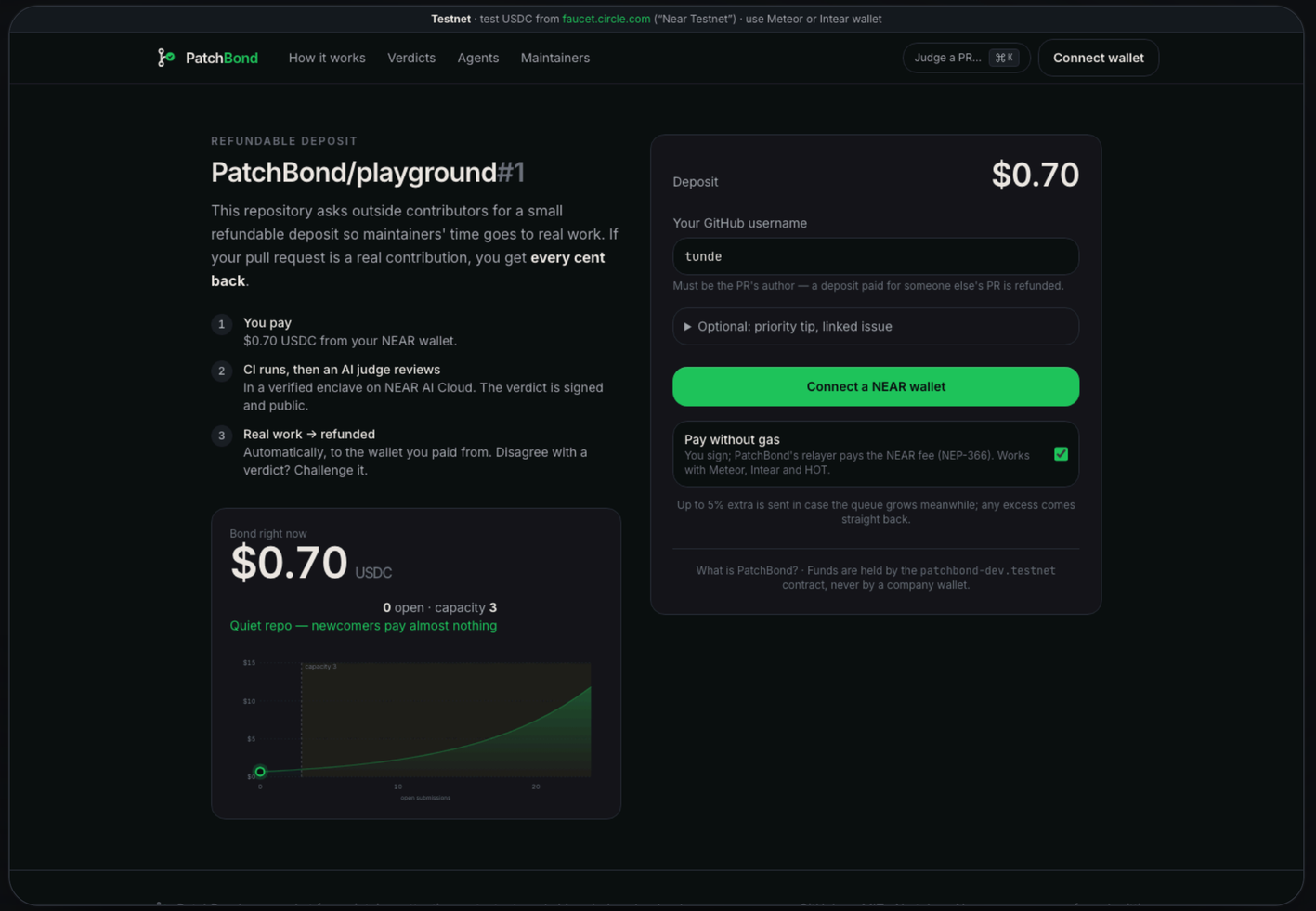
Real work: every cent back. Slop: 90% to the repo's vault.

The opposite of tea.xyz: spam **costs** money instead of earning it. No token. Nobody is paid for submitting.

One comment on the PR. One tap to pay.

The GitHub App asks strangers for a bond with the live price. They pay from any NEAR wallet — **gasless**: our relayer pays the fee (NEP-366).

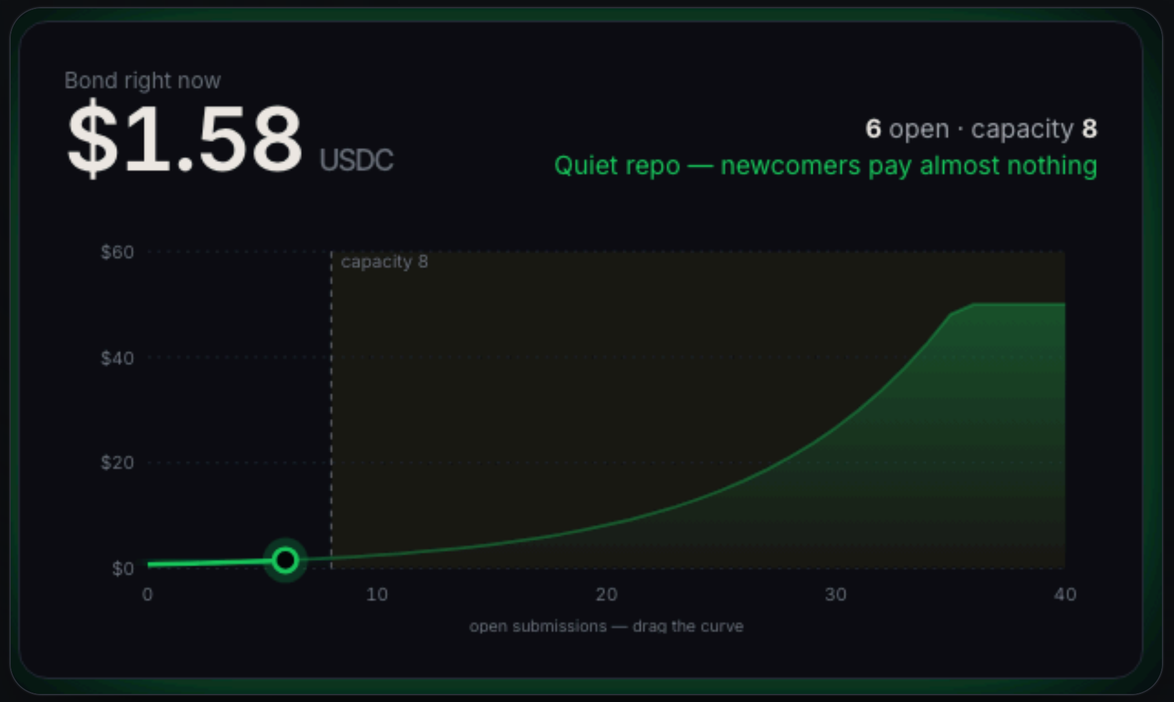
After CI, the verdict lands back on the PR as a check and a comment.



EDGE 1 · ATTENTION PRICING

EIP-1559 for maintainers.

The bond follows the repo's open queue — computed **on-chain** from unsettled deposits. Tens of PRs at once? Each one makes the next **12.5%** more expensive. A quiet repo costs a newcomer cents.



Quiet repo

6 open, capacity 8 → **$1.58**

Busy

14 open → **$4.05**

Spam wave

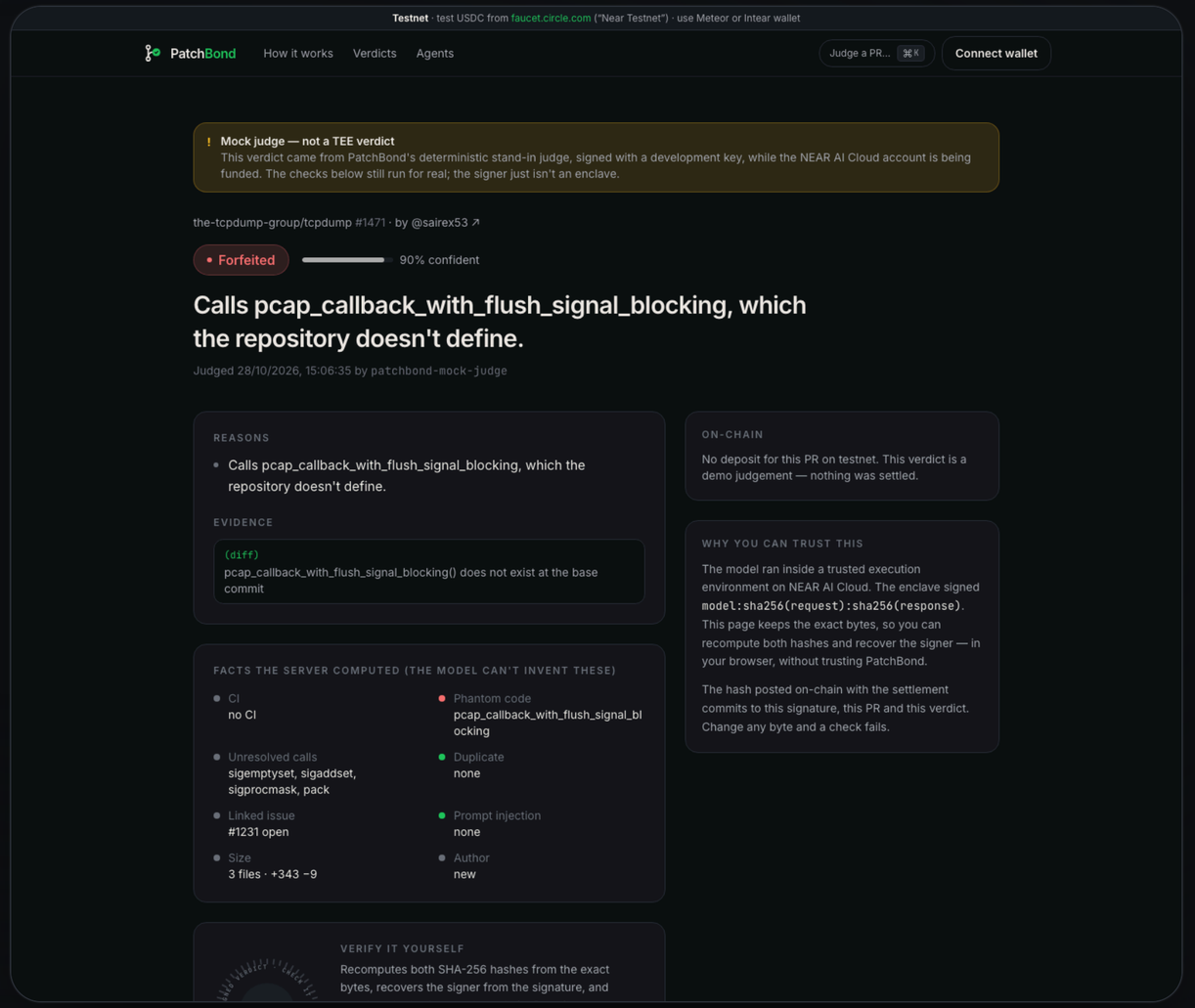
40 open → **$50 ceiling**

```
bond = clamp(min, max, base × 1.125^(open - capacity)) × reputation
```

Facts first. Then a verifiable model.

CI	The repo's own checks — we never run contributor code
Phantom code	Calls into the project's own namespace that don't exist
Claims vs diff	“Added tests”, “updated README” — is it in the diff?
Assignment	Was the issue assigned to someone else?
Injection	Text that tries to instruct the judge

A forfeit needs high confidence, evidence **and** a hard fact. When in doubt, refund.



0 of 15 good PRs forfeited on a labelled set of 30 real PRs

DON'T TRUST US — VERIFY

Every verdict is signed, public and checkable in your browser.

`sha256(request)` ✓

The exact bytes sent to the model in NEAR AI Cloud's TEE.

`sha256(response)` ✓

The exact answer — nothing edited after the fact.

`signer` ✓

The enclave's key, recovered from the signature (EIP-191).

`on-chain hash` ✓

The hash settled with the money commits to all of it.

shared/src/verify.ts — same code in browser and server

NOT A SLOP FILTER — A MARKET

Mechanisms nobody else has. One NEAR contract.

Priority lane

Pay for attention, not for submitting

A review tip reaches the repo only if a maintainer reviews within the promised window — otherwise it's refunded.

Optimistic verdicts

Cheap AI by default, strong AI when money's on the line

Stake to challenge; a stronger model re-judges with both sides' statements; the loser's stake pays the winner.

Slop funds the fix

Spam pays whoever really fixes the issue

A forfeited PR that claimed to fix #N becomes a bounty on #N, paid when a real fix is merged.

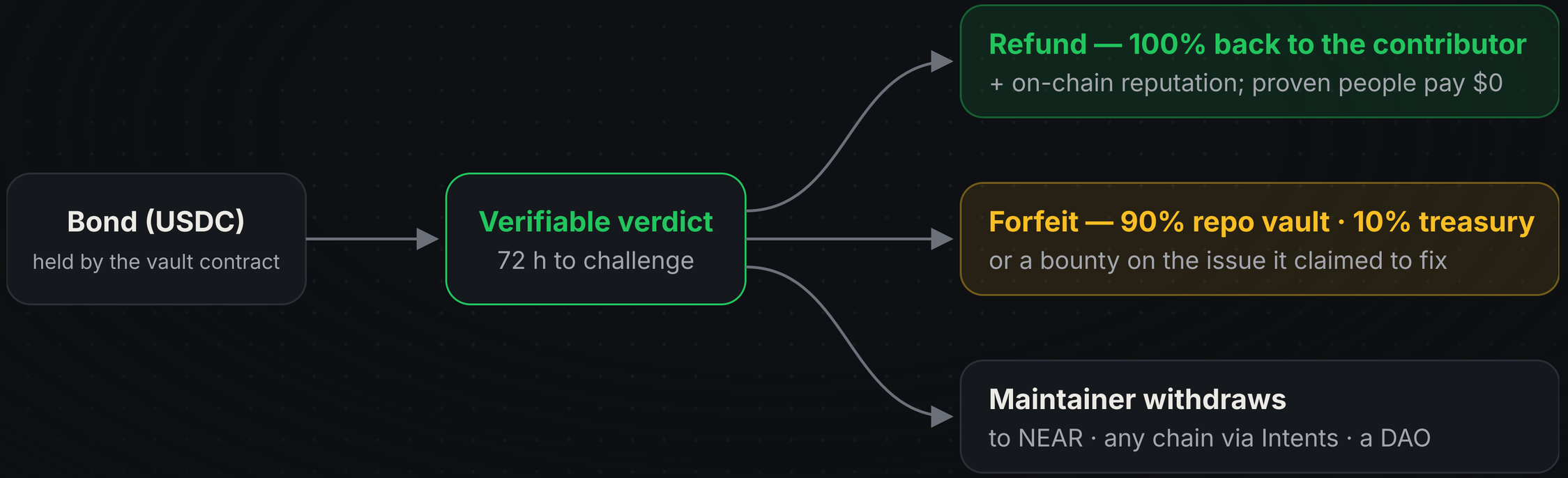
Agent passports

Capped wallets for coding agents

A function-call key that can only pay bonds, a daily cap enforced by the contract, a public record per harness.

WHERE THE MONEY GOES

Held by a contract — never by us.



Only the repo's linked payout account can withdraw — not the owner, not the oracle

Know your agent.

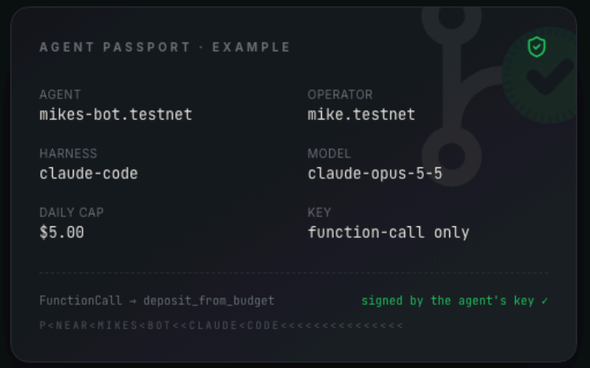
Coding agents pay bonds through our **MCP server** — with a key that can do nothing else. It refuses to start with a full-access key.

A **free pre-flight** tells the agent what the judge would flag *before* it pays.

KNOW YOUR AGENT

Coding agents are the senders now. Give them a wallet that can't hurt you.

An agent pays bonds from a budget you fund, signing with a NEAR **function-call key** that can call one method on one contract. The contract enforces the daily cap. Every payment carries a passport, and every harness earns a public, verifiable refund record.




```
$ bun run e2e:testnet # stage 9, real NEAR testnet
✓ MCP patchbond_deposit paid $1.00 with the function-call key
✓ third bond refused by the contract: “Daily cap reached…”
✓ the key can't touch the token contract
✓ the key can't call any other PatchBond method
```

BUILT ON NEAR

Every piece is a NEAR primitive.

NEAR AI Cloud	Verifiable inference in a TEE; signatures checked in the browser
Rust contract + NEP-297	Bonds, curve, verdicts, challenges, vaults, budgets, reputation
NEP-141 USDC	ft_transfer_call for bonds, challenges and agent budgets
Function-call keys	Capped agent wallets that can only pay bonds
Meta transactions (NEP-366)	Gasless bonds — our relayer pays the fee
NEP-413 signed messages	Maintainers prove wallet ownership to link a repo
NEAR Intents 1Click	Maintainers get paid on Base, Arbitrum, Ethereum or Solana
Sputnik DAO / Trezu	Hand a repo's vault to a project treasury

Paths to each in the README

PROOF, NOT PROMISES

Built, tested, and live on testnet.

49

real testnet transactions in one end-to-end run — every money path, a gasless bond, an agent via MCP. All passed.

97

automated tests: 33 contract (incl. a 50,000-case money property test), 64 TypeScript.

0/15

good PRs forfeited on a labelled set of 30 real PRs. When in doubt, refund.

- ✓ curve on-chain = curve in the app
- ✓ refund · 90/10 forfeit · void
- ✓ review tip earned / returned
- ✓ slop funds the fix
- ✓ challenge won after a real window
- ✓ gasless bond: 0 NEAR spent
- ✓ agent key can't escape its cap
- ✓ no USDC created or lost

Hardened against its own operator: a stolen oracle key can't redirect a vault. Threat model in SECURITY.md.

docs/e2e/testnet-report.md — one explorer link per transaction

Make your repo's attention worth something.

Maintainers

Install the GitHub App on one repo. Pilot with us — we'll tune the judge on your real PRs.

Agent builders

Plug in the MCP server. Give your agent a wallet that can't hurt you.

NEAR

Verifiable AI deciding where real money goes — in public, for open source.

github.com/PatchBond/patchbond

MIT · No token